

Patch Drywall & Fix Holes

The Complete Guide to Flawless Wall Repairs

Repair Steps

Essential Toolkit

Level 1: Tiny Nail Holes

Level 2: Doorknob Dents

Level 3: Large Holes

Sanding & Painting

The Repair Kit

- Lightweight Spackle
- Joint Compound
- Putty Knives (2" & 6")
- Mesh Tape
- Aluminum Wall Patches
- Sanding Sponge

LEVEL 1

Tiny Nail Holes

Perfect for fixing walls before moving out of a rental or rearranging art.

1. Push any raised edges into the hole with your putty knife handle.
2. Apply a dab of spackle and swipe flush.
3. Let dry for 30 minutes and sand lightly.

LEVEL 2

Doorknob Dents & Medium Holes

These require structural support so the spackle doesn't fall into the wall.

1. Stick an aluminum-backed mesh patch over the hole.
2. Apply joint compound over the patch.
3. **Feather the edges:** Thin out the compound 3 inches beyond the patch for a smooth transition.

***Pro Tip:** Two thin coats are much easier to sand and look better than one thick, lumpy coat.*

Sanding & Painting

Drywall compound is porous. If you paint directly over it, it will look different from the rest of the wall.

- **Sanding:** Run your hand over the repair. It should feel perfectly smooth.
- **Priming:** Use a dab of primer first.
- **Texturing:** Dab the paint on with a brush to recreate the "stipple" of the surrounding wall.